

MASTERING CORE

Mastering preparation, balance, lift, authority, and containment

Prepare, balance, polish, lift when needed, and contain the final program.

Included products: ANKH, SPHYNX, MAAT, Horizon X, PLATINUM

Recommended route: Choose one preparation stage, one balance or field stage, then ANKH. Place SESHAT last as observation only.

Family preset law: Factory presets describe musical intent and expose the useful range of the plugin. They do not change protected Input, Mix, Output, Power, or final ceiling controls unless the plugin's explicit canon requires it. Cathedral and SacredVerb retain their protected preset behavior. Preset changes must remain clickless.

Shell canon: Mastering Core uses a silver preset-shell stripe and machined silver/chrome frame. PLATINUM is a primary Mastering Core product.

ANKH



Sacred optical leveler for late-stage compression, Ma'at limiting, attack, release, drive, ratio, stereo link, Flower luminosity, and final containment.

Preferred placement: Master Field. Use late in the mastering chain for macro field structure or final containment.

Core controls

- Gain Match
- RA Input
- Mix
- Sekhem Attack
- Ma'at Release
- Ptah Drive
- Ascension Ratio
- Amun Output
- Compress

Meter and visualizer guide

These displays observe audio or processing state. They do not move controls unless the product description explicitly says otherwise.

Display	What it measures	How to read it
INPUT LEVEL	Peak level entering ANKH	Use to verify healthy mastering-chain entry.
GAIN REDUCTION	Current optical/limiter attenuation	More fill means more level is being removed.
OUTPUT LEVEL	Peak level after containment	Compare with Input for level-fair decisions.

Additional controls are mapped in the family technical manual.

Working method

Load a purpose-matched preset or begin from reset, bypass-match the result, then move one control at a time. Presets are starting points; protected gain and final output remain user decisions unless the plugin canon explicitly states otherwise.

SPHYNX



Mastering normalizer and calibrator that prepares input level, target, engine strength, normalization amount, mix, and output.

Preferred placement: Mix Bus. Use on the appropriate family bus, mix bus, or mastering chain with careful bypass matching.

Core controls

- Input
- Calibrate
- Normalize
- Engine
- Target
- Mix
- Output
- Gain Match

Meter and visualizer guide

These displays observe audio or processing state. They do not move controls unless the product description explicitly says otherwise.

Display	What it measures	How to read it
INPUT PEAK	Peak entering calibration	Confirms available headroom before normalization.
PROGRAM RMS	Average program energy	Use to understand body level, not final delivery loudness alone.
AUTO TRIM	Gain correction calculated by SPHYNX	Center is 0 dB; left cuts and right boosts.
OUTPUT PEAK	Peak after normalization	Verify headroom after calibration.
Crest / headroom	Peak-to-RMS and remaining space	Use together to avoid flattening transient structure.

Working method

Load a purpose-matched preset or begin from reset, bypass-match the result, then move one control at a time. Presets are starting points; protected gain and final output remain user decisions unless the plugin canon explicitly states otherwise.

MAAT



Mastering balance processor for foundation and air, bandwidth, truth, architecture, phase, stereo link, saturation mode, and output.

Preferred placement: Mix Bus. Use on the appropriate family bus, mix bus, or mastering chain with careful bypass matching.

Core controls

- Foundation Boost
- Foundation Atten
- Foundation Frequency
- Air Boost
- Air Atten
- Bandwidth
- Balance
- Truth
- Architecture

Meter and visualizer guide

These displays observe audio or processing state. They do not move controls unless the product description explicitly says otherwise.

Display	What it measures	How to read it
TRUTH	Composite tonal/phase balance score	Higher values mean the current foundation/air balance is closer to the intended field.
INPUT / OUTPUT	Live pre/post level	Use for level matching.
FOUNDATION	Low-frequency contribution	Shows active foundation energy.
AIR	Upper-frequency contribution	Shows active air energy.

Additional controls are mapped in the family technical manual.

Working method

Load a purpose-matched preset or begin from reset, bypass-match the result, then move one control at a time. Presets are starting points; protected gain and final output remain user decisions unless the plugin canon explicitly states otherwise.

Horizon X



Mastering finalizer with dawn/dusk states, volume, drive, maximizer, depth, clarity, gravity, pull, collapse, return, and blended Horizon/Event modes.

Preferred placement: Mix Bus. Use on the appropriate family bus, mix bus, or mastering chain with careful bypass matching.

Core controls

- Input
- Output
- Bypass
- RA Clip
- Gain Match
- Volume
- Drive
- Maximizer
- Depth

Meter and visualizer guide

These displays observe audio or processing state. They do not move controls unless the product description explicitly says otherwise.

Display	What it measures	How to read it
LIVE SIGNAL	Per-channel input RMS on a -60 to 0 dBFS scale	Shows program energy entering the finalizer.
FIELD STATE	Combined Horizon/Event processing state	A process-state visualization, not a delivery-loudness meter.
OUTPUT LEVEL	Post-finalizer level on a -60 to 0 dBFS scale	Use with LIVE SIGNAL for level-fair review.

Additional controls are mapped in the family technical manual.

Working method

Load a purpose-matched preset or begin from reset, bypass-match the result, then move one control at a time. Presets are starting points; protected gain and final output remain user decisions unless the plugin canon explicitly states otherwise.

PLATINUM



Mastering authority processor using silver air, gold drive, copper body, iron glue, nickel focus, platinum authority, and final output.

Preferred placement: Mix Bus. Use on the appropriate family bus, mix bus, or mastering chain with careful bypass matching.

Core controls

- Gain Match
- AG Air
- AU Drive
- CU Body
- FE Glue
- NI Focus
- PT Authority
- Output

Working method

Load a purpose-matched preset or begin from reset, bypass-match the result, then move one control at a time. Presets are starting points; protected gain and final output remain user decisions unless the plugin canon explicitly states otherwise.